

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 8

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to congratulate the University of Tennessee Volunteers baseball team, 2024 NCAA Men's College World Series champion.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor and commend those extraordinary athletic teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to the State of Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors of this State; and

WHEREAS, the University of Tennessee (UT) Volunteers baseball team recently completed one of the greatest seasons in the history of the university's baseball program, as the team took home its first NCAA Men's College World Series championship in program history and finished the season with a 60-13 record; and

WHEREAS, the first No. 1 national seed to win the national title since 1999, the UT Volunteers defeated Texas A&M University 6-5 on Monday, June 25, 2024, to win the 2024 NCAA Men's College World Series, a testament to the dedication, perseverance, and work ethic of the players, coaches, and staff of the UT Volunteers baseball program; and

WHEREAS, the 2024 UT Volunteers baseball team is the first sixty-win Southeastern Conference baseball team in history; and

WHEREAS, the UT Volunteers baseball team set a National Collegiate Athletics Association record with five players recording twenty or more homeruns during the 2024 season; and

WHEREAS, each member of the UT Volunteers coaching staff deserves recognition, including Head Coach Tony Vitello, Associate Head Coach Josh Elander, Assistant Coach Frank Anderson, Assistant Coach Richard Jackson, Director of Player Development Luke Bonfield, and Student Assistant Coach Parker Serrano; and

WHEREAS, the members of the UT Volunteers baseball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the outstanding 2024 team is composed of players Christian Moore, Ariel Antigua, Alex Perry, Cannon Peebles, Bradke Lohry, Nate Snead, Dylan Dreiling, Hunter Ensley, Cal Stark, Billy Amick, Ethan Payne, Reese Chapman, Charlie Taylor, JJ Garcia, Dalton Bargo, Robin Villeneuve, AJ Causey, Andrew Behnke, Colby Backus, Kavares Tears, Dean Curley, Blake Burke, Chris Stamos, Aaron Combs, Brady Robertson, Stone Lawless, Austin Hunley, Drew Beam, AJ Russell, Derek Schaefer, Kirby Connell, Blake Grimmer, Dylan Loy, Hunter High, Camden Bates, Luke Payne, Marcus Phillips, Brayden Sharp, and Zander Sechrist; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in honoring this extraordinary group of young men who have indelibly written their names for all time into the annals of the College World Series; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Head Coach Tony Vitello and the University of Tennessee Volunteers baseball team upon their 2024 NCAA Men's College World Series championship and extend to them our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.